



Delphi

A sanctuary dedicated to the god Apollo and considered by the Greeks to be the center of the world

Set among the magnificent peaks of Mount Parnassus, Delphi was a site of mystical importance in the ancient world. The religious sanctuary established there in the 7th century BCE was the seat of Pythia—the high priestess of the Temple of Apollo, better known as the Oracle of Delphi. Sought out for her prophecies and judgments, which drew on the spirit of Apollo, the Oracle was one of the most famous women in the ancient world.

Temple rebuilt

The Temple of Apollo was rebuilt once following a fire and again after an earthquake, and the remains there today—the temple's foundations and several Doric columns—are from the structure built in 330 BCE. Around the temple were numerous other buildings, the remains of which can still be seen. Most notable of these are a theater with a capacity of 5,000 spectators; a stadium to host the Pythian games; the treasuries; and several lesser temples, including the Tholos, a temple dedicated to the goddess Athena Pronoia.

Delphi **hosted the Pythian Games**, second to the Olympic Games in importance



△ THE THOLOS AT DELPHI

Delphi has been extensively excavated in modern times, and some structures have been partially restored, including the Tholos, which originally consisted of a circle of 20 Doric columns around a core of 10 Corinthian columns.



RESILIENT DESIGN

The Pont du Gard's strength results from the use of meticulously cut stones requiring a minimum of mortar. It also stems from the three-tier design: each successive level is slightly narrower than the one below; the main piers are aligned vertically; and each arch is individually constructed to compensate for possible subsidence.

